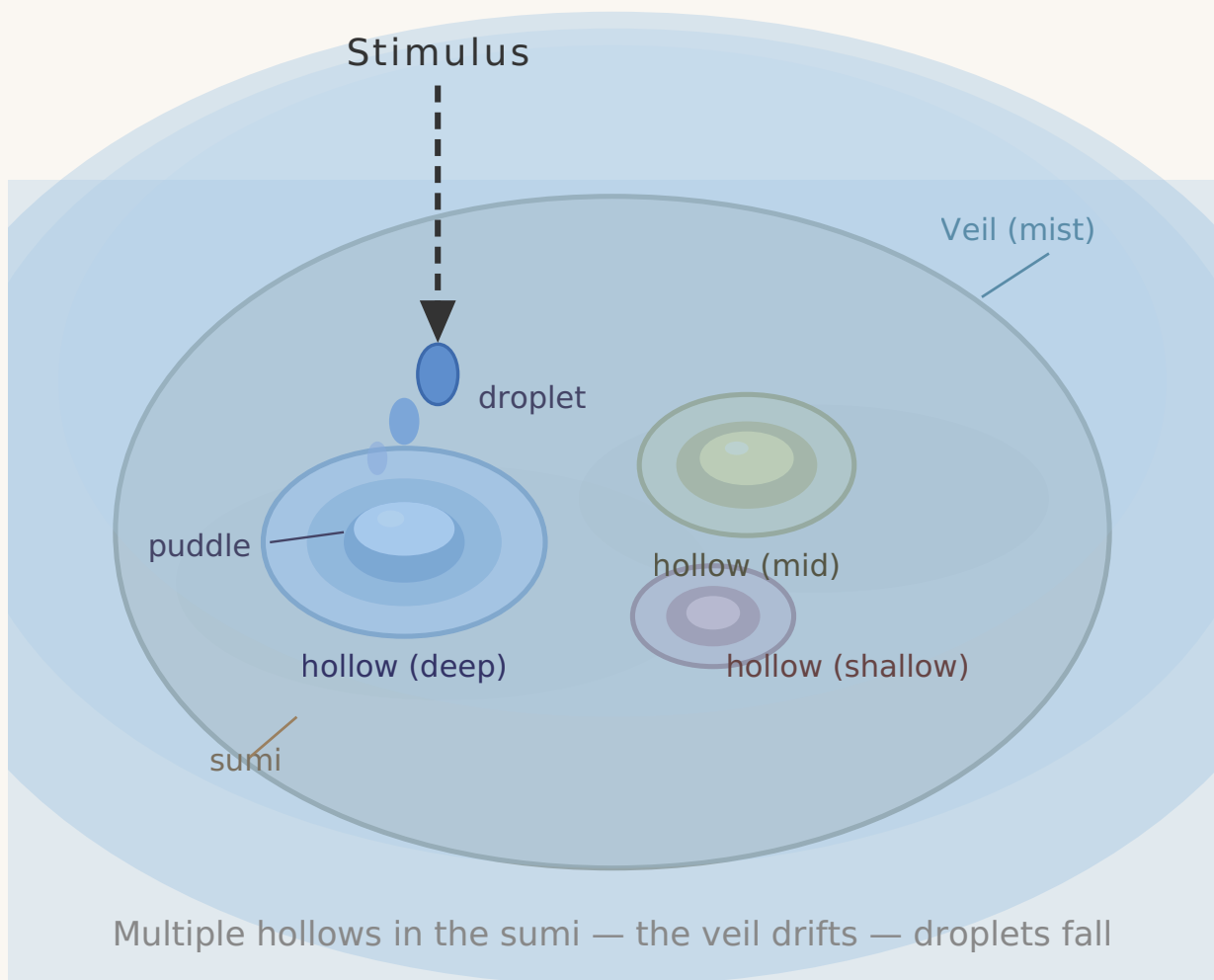


The Puddle Theory

Structural Diagrams — Extended Version | Weird and Observers, June 2026

1 Overview — The Landscape of the Mind

sumi: the innate, solid material of the vessel — like the ink stick used in Japanese calligraphy, ground to release its quality, unique to each person.

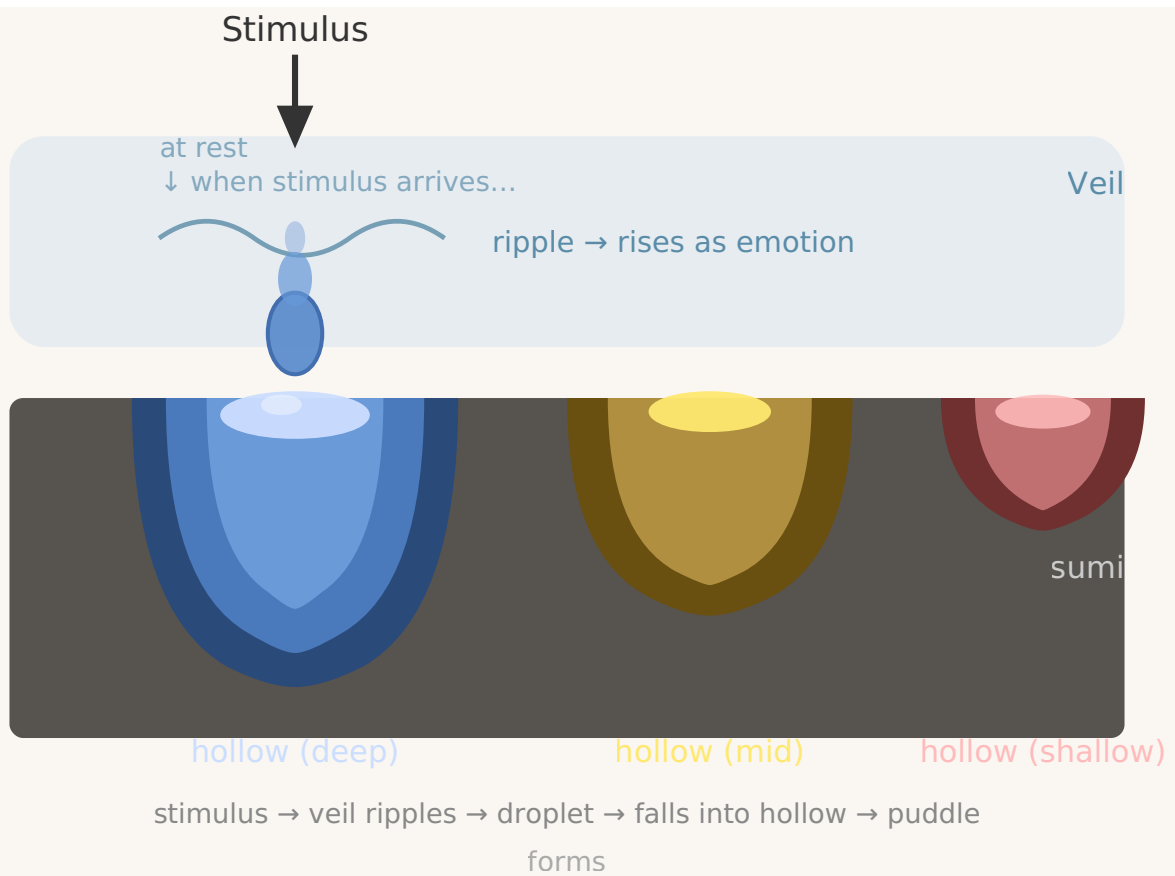


The Veil (mist) drifts both inside and beyond the vessel.

Sumi is not uniform — its quality varies from place to place.

Between hollows there is no wall, only a continuous stretch of sumi. Multiple puddles rise at once.

2 Cross-section — From Stimulus to Puddle

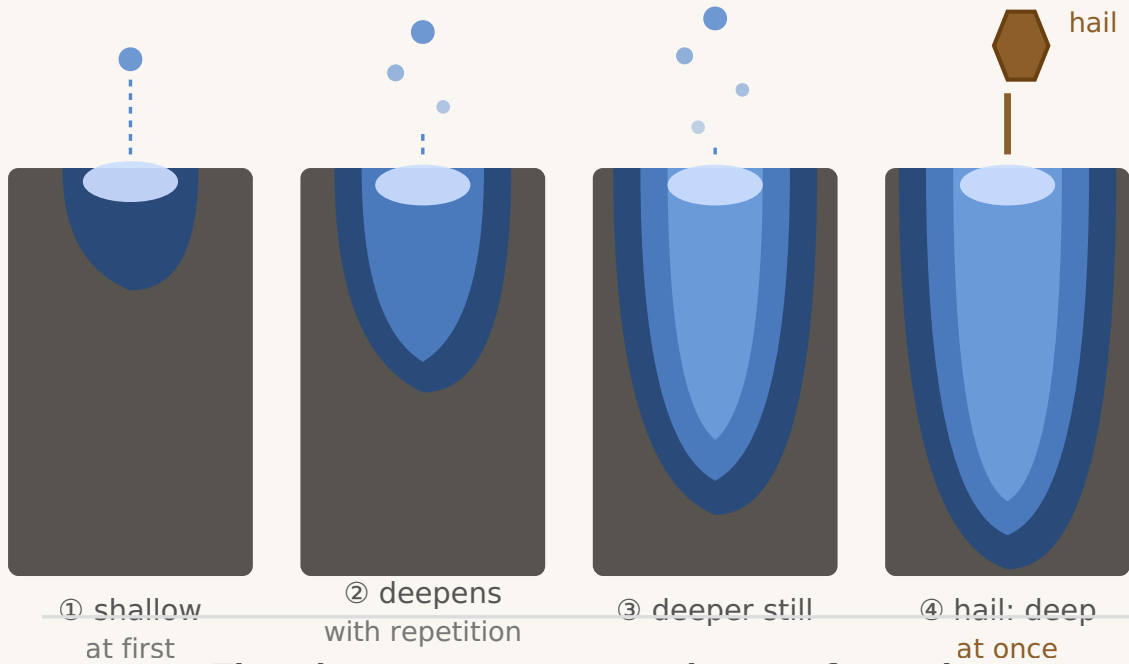


The Veil rests in a quiet state. When a stimulus arrives, the Veil ripples — and emotion rises as a droplet.

The droplet falls into a hollow and becomes a puddle. The deeper the hollow, the larger the puddle that rises.

3 The Hollow Deepens Over Time — Irreversibility

Time



Though we waver, we can only move forward.

— Irreversibility —

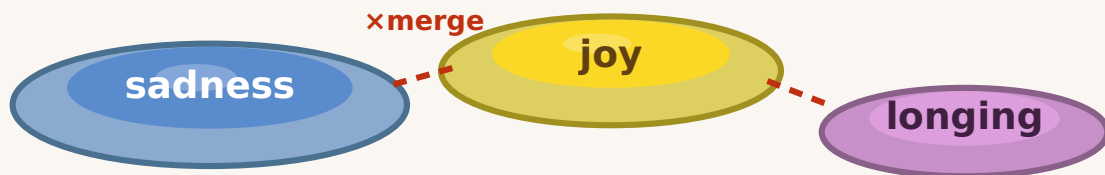
A hollow, once dug, cannot be undug.

A droplet, once gone, cannot be recalled.

Rain (gentle stimuli) deepens a hollow slowly, through repetition. Hail (intense stimuli) cuts deep in a single blow.
Either way, once a hollow is dug, it does not undo itself — irreversibility.

"happy, and yet aching"

inside one "I", simultaneously

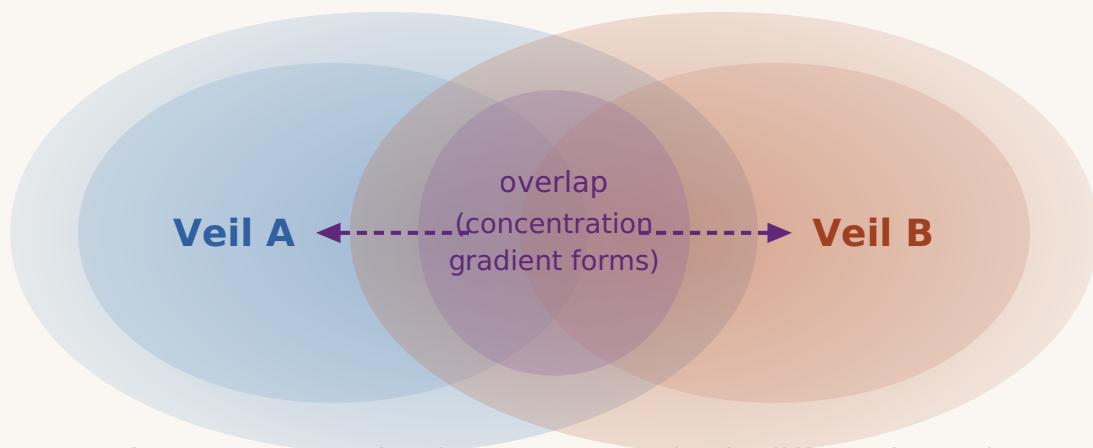


Multiple puddles rise together — without collapsing into one.

A single stimulus can give rise to multiple droplets at once. Each puddle rises on its own — they do not merge.

"Happy, and yet aching" is not contradiction. It is the core of the theory.

5 Merging (Dyeing) — Two Veils Touch



After contact, each other's essence slowly diffuses inward.
Even alone again, the state lingers for a while.

When two Veils touch, a concentration gradient forms at the overlap. From there, each other's essence slowly diffuses.

The words of someone we spoke with deeply keep spreading inside us days later — this is the diffusion of merging.